Kaden Huynh

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Education

University of California, Santa Barbara — Santa Barbara, CA
Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Political Science, Minor in Philosophy — *Sep 2024 - Jun 2027*
- Cumulative GPA: 3.87/4.0 | Honors: Dean's Honor List, National Political Science Honor Society
- Relevant Coursework: Political Theory (Classical, Modern, Contemporary)

International Christian University, UCEAP — Tokyo, Japan
- Relevant Coursework: Japanese Politics, Modern Moral Philosophy, America and the World — *Sep 2026 - Dec 2026*

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, UCEAP — Barcelona, Spain
- Relevant Coursework: Leadership and Negotiation Techniques, Critical Thinking — *Jun 2026 - Aug 2026*

Experience

UCSB Campus Learning Assistance Services (CLAS) — Santa Barbara, CA
Writing Tutor — *Expected Jan 2027*
- Selected to tutor students one-on-one in prompt analysis, drafting, structure, argumentation, and revision.

Pho Ha Grill & Bar — Oceanside, CA
Shift Lead — *Dec 2021 – Dec 2025*
- Improved peak-period coverage by leading a 10+ person team and training 5 new hires to speed up onboarding, while handling thousands of dollars in sales transactions each shift in a fast-paced restaurant environment.
- Grew online orders by 25% by analyzing Grubhub, DoorDash, and Uber Eats performance metrics to identify inefficiencies, then implementing UI changes and optimizations across all three major delivery platforms.

In-N-Out — San Diego, CA
Associate — *Dec 2023 – Aug 2024*
- Collaborated with 30+ crew members across simultaneous stations to keep high-volume service consistent.
- Delivered professional, customer-first service to hundreds of guests every shift, upholding quality standards.

Leadership & Activities

Vietnamese Buddhist Youth Association — San Diego, CA
Youth Leader — *May 2019 - Present*
- Raised thousands in flood-relief aid for Vietnam by organizing community prayer and banquet fundraisers.
- Sustained attendance for 60+ members by running weekly meetings, summer camps, and volunteer drives.

National Speech & Debate Association — San Diego, CA
Parliamentary Debater — *Aug 2020 - Jun 2024*
- Earned a varsity performance award for persuasive speaking against hundreds of peers across California.
- Researched, synthesized sources, and drafted written cases on rotating resolutions across policy, international relations, and ethics, analyzing unfamiliar issues and refuting complex arguments under strict time pressure.

Projects

Legal CRM — Jun 2026
Web Application | JavaScript, Supabase, Claude API, Google Workspace
- Built a legal CRM with a searchable contact directory, built-in Gmail inbox, and calendar-based follow-ups.
- Cut outreach email drafting time by 90% across a growing network of 50+ attorneys, judges, and mentors by using AI to automatically convert meeting notes into structured contact records and personalized emails.

Athena — May 2026
Web Application | React, Node.js, Supabase, Claude API, Mapbox
- Architected a web app that ingests short-form media, web links, and PDFs and uses a Claude API tool call to transcribe, summarize, and categorize each item in a searchable, mapped archive for fast and easy retrieval.
- Improved classification accuracy and UX for 10+ private-beta users by shipping feedback-driven iterations.

Skills & Interests

Languages: Fluent in English and Spanish, Proficient in Vietnamese
Technical: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, AI/LLM integration
Interests: Boxing, Piano, Poker, Volleyball, Weightlifting, Traveling, Content Creation